

PRINCIPLES

1. Keep your rook and king on opposite colors from the enemy bishop.
2. Use your rook to cut off the enemy king's escape routes.
3. Coordinate your rook and king to control key squares and limit the opponent's king movement.
4. Aim to drive the enemy king to the edge of the board.
5. Be aware of the stalemate possibilities when the enemy king is cornered.
6. Use the bishop to control squares that the rook cannot reach.
7. Always look for opportunities to check the enemy king with your rook.
8. Maintain flexibility in your pieces to adapt to the opponent's moves.
9. Avoid placing your king in a position where it can be attacked by the enemy rook.
10. Practice the technique of checkmating with rook and bishop against a lone king.

SITUATION

In this position, Black threatens to promote a pawn by moving the king to b2. White must act quickly to prevent this while also threatening to move to b1. The black king is limited in movement, and White's king is well-placed to block the pawn's advance. The goal is to keep the black king from escaping and to control the promotion square effectively.

FEN: 8/1p3K2/8/8/8/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White aims to prevent the black king from promoting the pawn while maintaining control of key squares. Black's goal is to promote the pawn and escape the corner. The position is critical for White to maintain the opposition and control the escape routes.

STRATEGY

The strategy involves using the white king to block the black king's path while the rook controls the promotion square. By keeping the rook and king on opposite colors from the black bishop, White can effectively limit the black king's movement. The key is to maintain pressure and prevent the black king from escaping to the promotion square.

MOVES

First, move your king to c1 to prevent the black king from advancing. If Black responds with Ka2, continue with Kc2 to keep the black king cornered. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Kc1 Ka2 2. Kc2 a4 3. Kc1 a3 4. Kc2 Ka1 5. Kc1.

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson illustrates the importance of keeping your rook and king on opposite colors from the enemy bishop (Principle 1). It also emphasizes the need to cut off the enemy king's escape routes (Principle 2) while coordinating your pieces to control key squares (Principle 3).